

the Pro-Mini is an Uno with half the clockspeed and 16% the area, a Nano is an Uno with half the flash memory and SRAM at 22% the area, and a Micro is an Uno at 24% the area. Interestingly, the price ratios are not too different from the area ratios.

LilyPad Arduino

In the spirit of Arduino Uno comparisons, this one is a Uno for wearables. Designed to be sewn on with ease, this one has quite a few variants – USB, Simple (with fewer I/O pins), Simple Snap (Can be snapped in and out, making wearables easy to wash).

Arduino 101

Designed in collaboration with Intel, this one comes with the Intel Curie module while retaining the robust form factor and peripheral list of the Uno. Additionally, it contains Bluetooth LE capabilities and a 6-axis gyrometer. As it must have been obvious from the inclusion of the Curie module, this one is great for making wearables and is the newest kid around the block.

Phew, that was something. The Arduino family is exhaustive, isn't it? And it seems to be going good. Let's just say that Maker Tech is about to get a lot more interesting.

Meanwhile, back in 2006, while the Arduino was being prototyped and slowly nudged into the market, something else was in the works for the Makers around the world.

UK brings the Pi to the party

Raspberry Pi, developed by Raspberry Pi Foundation, is another micro-controller chip initially developed with the aim of helping students learn more about computers. Inspired by the BBC Micro computer (developed by Acorn Computers), the initial prototype in 2006 had one USB port and one HDMI port.

The first Pi came in two models, Model A at 25\$ and Model B at 35\$. The difference in price was due to the presence of an Ethernet port and an additional USB port in model B, and other than that the hardware was identical.

A Broadcom BCM2835 system, that comprised of the ARM1176JZF-S 700MHz CPU with a Videocore IV GPU (maintained in all Pis) was present in the first Pi along with 256MB RAM. On the side of ports, along with the USB and HDMI mentioned earlier, it also came with an SD card slot and a 3.5mm audio port, all in the size of a credit card.